

adaptability, self-evaluation, and growth, qualities that will become even more critical over the next five to ten years as clients mature and leadership requires a balance between softer responsibilities and commercial performance.”

THE STRENGTHS

Shivakumar sees a clear advantage in hiring quieter and ambivert leaders. “People feel this person will listen, will give them a chance, will be balanced. As a result, they are at their natural best and say what’s on their mind,” he says. Such leaders bring “reflection, inquisitiveness, and quiet confidence,” creating a space where employees feel heard and valued.

Ambivert leaders occupy a unique middle ground in the Indian context. Patel explains: “They can inspire both introverts and extroverts, handle diverse tasks and levels of engagement, create inclusive environments, and excel in high-pressure situations with a calm, balanced perspective combined with thoughtful decision-making.” Their ability to move between energising teams and stepping back to reflect makes them well suited to the complexity of modern workplaces. However, Patel cautions that context matters. “Clients who want charismatic leaders due to business context and culture may see ambiverts as a less compelling choice. But those prioritising balance often view them as the right fit.”

LEARNED SKILL AND STRATEGIC EDGE

Can ambivert leadership be developed? Parashar believes it can. “Personality can shape where you start, but the ability to flex, to stretch into behaviours outside

your default, can be built,” she says. Drawing from her coaching experience, she explains how introverts train themselves to speak up more while extroverts work on listening and reflection. “I often recommend micro-practices, small, intentional shifts, like an introvert taking up a visible project, or an extrovert holding back his opinion until others

speak. Over time, these create big changes,” says Parashar. In India, where leaders often lean towards recognition and power, stress can push them towards excessive boldness or impulsiveness. “They start working on a more balanced style through feedback and reflection,” she adds.

Parashar sees ambiversion as a clear competitive advantage.



HOW TO NURTURE AMBIVERT LEADERSHIP

► **Challenge the Extrovert Bias:** Move past the preference for loud leaders; value those who balance presence, reflection, and action

► **Invest in Coaching:** Coaching fosters self-awareness and skill development. Extroverts can learn to listen and create space for others, while introverts can build visibility and influence

► **Design Inclusive Workplaces:** Hybrid models support ambiversion by enabling deep work and collaboration. Practices

like sharing agendas in advance and written inputs give quieter voices the room to contribute

► **Normalise Energy Management:** Let leaders recharge their way. Introverts may need solitude, and extroverts interaction, to sustain flexibility and performance

► **Balance Confidence with Humility:** Results must come with responsibility and community focus. Outward confidence matters, but reflection, listening, and adaptability now define true strength